

CURRICULUM VITAE

IFEANYI EPHRAIM AWUNOR

Prospective PhD Candidate (Historical & Cultural Studies / Performance & Ritual Studies)

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Nationality: Nigerian

Research Regions: Nigeria, West Africa

Research Fields: Cultural History, Ritual Performance, Migration, Masquerade Studies, Traditional Authority

RESEARCH PROFILE

I am a scholar of Theatre and Performance Studies with strong interdisciplinary grounding in cultural history and anthropology. My research focuses on migration, ritual performance, masquerade traditions, cultural hybridity, and indigenous political institutions in West Africa. I employ historical analysis, ethnographic methods, and performance-based interpretation to examine how migrant communities negotiate identity, authority, and continuity.

Proposed PhD Title: Migration, Cultural Hybridity, and Traditional Authority: The Cultural Formation of the Ubulubu Migrant Community in Nigeria

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (M.A.) in Theatre Arts — 2023

University of Benin, Benin City, Nigeria

- Dissertation: *Rebirth of African Theatre: Austin Asagba's Prodigy of Essence* (2024)
- Focus: African theatre aesthetics, ritual performance, cultural identity

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Theatre Arts — 2020

University of Benin, Benin City, Nigeria

- Research Project: *A Critical Analysis of the Concept of African Theatre: A Case Study of Sam Ukala's Folkism*

Nigeria Certificate in Education (N.C.E.) – Theatre Arts / English Language — 2009

College of Education, Agbor, Nigeria

PUBLICATIONS & RESEARCH OUTPUT

Awunor, I. E. (2025). **Dramaturgical challenges of moral characterization in Nigerian plays: A study of selected plays.** *Benin Journal of Music and the Arts (BENJMA)*, 4.
ISSN Online: 2992-5223 | ISSN Print: 2992-5215

Awunor, I. E. (Accepted). **Traditional institutions as pathway to resolving governance dysfunctionalities in Nigeria.** *Nigerian Journal of Administrative Science (NJAS)*, 7.

CONFERENCES & ACADEMIC TRAINING

- **Nigerian Universities Theatre Arts Festival (NUTAF)**, University of Benin — April 2017
- **Nigerian Catholic Youth Leadership Training**, Boy Scouts of America (Scouting University) — November 2017

ACADEMIC & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Training Coordinator / External Instructor — 2019–Present
EPHIRA I.T & Educational Resources, University of Benin (Ekehuan Campus)

- Academic training coordination
- Instruction in communication, digital literacy, and media tools

English Language & Literature Teacher — 2010–2014
Living Stone College, Ikorodu, Lagos State

- Secondary-level instruction in English and literature

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATION

- **Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN)** — ED/R/16557 (2025)

ACADEMIC SERVICE & LEADERSHIP (SELECTED)

- President, Nigerian Federation of Catholic Students — University of Benin (2018–2019)
- Secretary, Catholic Youth Organization of Nigeria — Catholic Diocese of Issele-Uku (2015–2020)
- President, Catholic Youth Organization of Nigeria — St. Paul's Cathedral, Issele-Uku (2013–2016)

RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Qualitative research & ethnographic documentation
- Archival and oral history research
- Performance analysis & cultural interpretation

- Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
- Graphic & media tools: CorelDraw, Photoshop, Pinnacle Studio

LANGUAGES

- English — Native / Academic
- Yoruba- derived Ubulubu dialect — Native
- Igbo — Conversational
- German — Beginner (reading knowledge; willing to undertake formal training)

REFEREES

Prof. Josephine A. Abbe

Head of Department, Theatre Arts
University of Benin, Nigeria

Prof. Chris E. Ugolo

Department of Theatre Arts
University of Benin, Nigeria

Prof. Austin O. Asagba

Department of Theatre Arts
University of Benin, Nigeria